Fox Spills the Stars

© Center for the Collaborative Classroom

retold by Amy Helfer ☆ illustrated by Michelle Lopez Deksnys

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When time was just starting, there was a sun.

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But there were no stars. When the sun set, the sky turned as black as tar.

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It was so dark that it was hard to see. The people didn't like it.

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So they asked Father Sky for help.

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Father Sky was very smart. He thought and he thought.
Then he held a meeting.

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"I have thought and thought," said Father Sky.
"And I have a plan."

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Father Sky held out a shining jar. It was sealed with a cork.

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"We will hang some stars," he said. "I will tell you where to put each one."

And he did.

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The stars formed shapes like a bear or a hunter.
Father Sky gave each shape a name.

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The people still had more stars to hang. No one saw Fox hiding.

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Fox saw the sky and thought, "The dark is good for tricks. No more stars!"

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Fox grabbed the jar and ran toward home.

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He tripped! The cork popped out, and the rest of the stars darted up to the sky.

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There, they still shine. But most of them have no names.

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